

News and Views: Reading & Responses

Name _____

Date _____

Read the articles and complete the activities for each section. You may record your answers and tables electronically, or print this out, fill out tables by hand and write out answers.

All sections and activities need to be completed.

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Comparing different perspectives

- Analyse and compare
- Answer questions

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- Answer questions
- Complete analysis chart

SECTION 5

“Drugs” by Karl Quinn

- answer questions, complete chart
- Write two short answers (200 words each).

SECTION 1

The Guardian 13 November 2015

Don't think you're superior to me because you're not on Facebook



Suzanne Moore

It's time to understand that social media, for all its performance aspect, isn't the binary opposite to real life. It is real life

A Facebook sabbatical can make you 55% happier and 100% more smug. Photograph: Alamy



Shares: 5,512

Comments: 908

Hello! Here I am waving at you from my platform. This platform may be print, it may be on your laptop, it may be on your phone. It may be retweeted or have popped up as a Facebook share. It may be a link you ignore. Underneath this platform, zillions of people who feel they don't have enough of a platform will explain in their made-up names why this is the most pointless thing they have ever read.

Their opinion matters. If they can squash it into 140 characters they may tweet me some hate. Usually some sub-Chomskian nonsense about Jeremy Corbyn and the dead-tree press. They will mostly agree with each other ... so that's nice.

Such is the media now. All media is social media and everyone is a critic. We live in constant TripAdvisor mode. I am a hotel that did not impress you much. I am the Uber driver you only gave two stars to. I am a waste of space that you could not even be bothered to read, simply to slag off. Because there is no comment without comment. If a column is not retweeted does it even exist?

If I want "real life" I pull back from Twitter— increasingly a circle-jerk of men arguing about the Labour party or people engaged in bland self-promotion – and I go on Facebook. As Twitter's growth stalls, Facebook's continues. I can't say I am surprised. There, I find it possible to disagree without anyone threatening to kill me or my children. I find this reassuring. As I don't work in an office, I like the mundane chats, the silly jokes, the music. Sure, I will never get over the amount of cats and babies; though I have had both, I find them essentially boring. But I am not a fascist and accept this is something people do. Though I would no more photograph my cat than sext Philip Hammond.

Mostly I show off or moan. Both are pleasurable. But increasingly I find the moral superiority about quitting social media in favour of real life somewhat grating. What does this even mean? The idea of “really sharing” as opposed to larking about online? This is usually accompanied by a parental rant about kids living on their phones, their lives mediated and somehow unlived. It is as if my generation spent their childhoods climbing trees instead of being passively plonked on the sofa watching godawful telly presented by paedophiles.

Sure there is a level of performance to social media. The sucking in of cheeks and stomachs and the constant presentation of femininity as something that needs to be “liked” was not invented by Instagram. Instead of tutting, educate your children about consent over imagery and explain that Google is not a primary source.

Yet we have this stupid anxiety because we cannot admit that social media is not the binary opposite of real life. It is real life. This is why studies such as the latest one from Denmark somehow just perpetuate this smugness. Half the participants were given access to Facebook, the other half went cold turkey for a week. Those who had a break felt “55% less stressed”. Comparing ourselves with our peers causes unhappiness, you see. May I just add here that the Danes, though materially well off, have high rates of depression. The study showed those who quit Facebook felt less lonely and more connected to real people.

These sorts of studies strike me as self-satisfied. Sure, take a break. A social media detox. Drink your Nutribullet green gunge instead of photographing it. Help the old lady next door. Have some spiritual connection instead of joking with friends who aren’t even “real” online. After all, you have free choice over these free apps. If you are “addicted” and can no longer function, work or have relationships, then there is a problem. But this addiction model is questionable. Are we addicted to television, reading, music? Why is chatting so bad? Why is having so much access to so much information dangerous? I can sit with the same old friend and have the same old conversation, or I can play with new people who tell me new things. Both are real. Both can be brilliant.

If Twitter is stagnating, then it is partly to do with its failure to deal with abuse but also its infantilisation of users. Do I want to “heart” a picture of some drowning refugees? No I don’t.

Facebook, meanwhile, is bombarding us with ads, but it is also giving us a little more control over which “friends” see what. The point is that none of this is compulsory. You may connect or not. You may show off or not. You may find love or not. You may or may not win the popularity contest. For this, I am afraid, is essentially life. So don’t bore me with your self-imposed sabbaticals; I accept you are a better person than me, who fully connects in a deeper way than I can manage.

For I am quite happy on social media, waving not drowning. My friends there will come and rescue me if I need help. For we have only connected.

Don't think you're superior to me because you're not on Facebook

Suzanne Moore

Activity

- 1 Explain the following words and phrases from the article, in context:

Binary opposite	
sabbatical	
fascist	
We live in constant Tripadvisor mode	
Twitter	
Moral superiority	

Google is not a primary source	
Infantalisation	

2. What is the writer's perspective on social media?

3. Give your opinion on the topic.

SECTION 2

News reports involve a process of **selection and omission**. Consider the following replicated press release from a traffic policing service and the different versions of the story presented in two news reports.

Read the two versions of an event as reported by *Newvoices.com.au* and a local online news service and complete the following activity.

PRESS RELEASE:

Warning for driving dangerously

9 September 2015, 06:10am

Two women are being questioned after driving a car into a row of garbage bins late last night.

The female driver narrowly missed two pedestrians before coming to a stop on Thomas Road.

Police arrived soon after the accident and took statements from the people involved. Charges are unlikely to be laid.

No one was hurt but it comes as a timely reminder to be cautious when driving in view of this year's rising road toll.

VERSION 1:

Lucky escape

Two pedestrians had a lucky escape last night as a car veered out of control.

'The girl skidded across Thomas Street in what appeared to be a drunken haze,' bystander John Stock said. He claims more police need to patrol this busy street for reckless drivers on the weekend.

Empty bottles were found at the scene but charges are yet to be laid.

VERSION 2:

Driving tired warning

Last night a reminder about the risk of driving tired occurred when two pedestrians narrowly escaped a swerving car.

The female driver allegedly lost control of her car as she fell asleep driving along Thomas Road.

She applied the brakes just in time and veered into garbage bins. She remained at the scene with a female passenger until police arrived.

The police say no charges are likely to be laid.

Activity

Using the ‘Comparing Versions of the News’ document, record the similarities and differences between each version in the table provided.

‘Comparing Versions of the News’

Quotation	Version one: Lucky escape	Version two: Driving tired warning
Record the information from the press release used by each version.		
Record information that each version has used in addition to the press release.		

Quotation	Version one: Lucky escape	Version two: Driving tired warning
Describe the slant each report constructs about this incident.		

SECTION 3 - COMPARING DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVES

The following two news reports were written about the same event. The first story is from *The West Australian* online news service and the second report was written for *Newvoices.com.au*.

Riot police called out to control drunk teens

Angela Pownall

The West Australian

August 30, 2015, 2:15 am

Shocked neighbours told of parents dropping off underage children with cartons of liquor as riot police tried to quell up to 200 drunk and unruly teenagers at a violent 15th birthday party in Mandurah on Saturday.

Police said the parents who supplied the alcohol were irresponsible after up to 30 officers in riot gear were called in to quell the violence.

The police helicopter was also sent to Brandon Wadley's party in Cassilis Court, Greenfields, after terrified neighbours called for help when the celebration turned ugly.

The quiet cul-de-sac was more like an inner-city ghetto by 9pm when 14 patrol cars cordoned it off to break up the out-of-control party and stop more people joining in.

Revellers threw bottles and rocks at houses and police while others used backyards to get to the Wadley home.

Neighbour Steve Ramble said there were about 200 people in the street, which was strewn with broken glass, and his house was pelted with bottles.

'The kids had to stay inside away from the windows,' he said. 'They were terrified. The police did what they could but it was a bit too late.'

He was shocked to see parents dropping children off as riot police battled to disperse the mob.

'How could you let your child in there when riot police are trying to get people out?' he said. 'As a parent, you can't imagine it.'

Men aged 42 and 19 were arrested for disorderly conduct. No one was injured.

Insp Danny Mulligan said the behaviour was antisocial, unacceptable and disgusting and the parents of children involved were irresponsible.

It was disappointing that police had had to quell large-scale disturbances in Mandurah three times this month.

An officer was injured when youths threw bottles and rocks at police at a birthday party in the CWA Hall.

Just 24 hours earlier, riot police were called from Perth to an out-of-control 16th birthday party in Salmon Gums Lane, Dawesville, where some of the 200 partygoers threw rocks and bottles at officers.

Insp Mulligan said police would talk to Brandon's parents about the party and would establish whether offences took place.

Brandon's father Aaron Wadley declined to comment but Brandon told the ABC gatecrashers from Rockingham were to blame.

(Reproduced courtesy *The West Australian*.)

Parents claim misleading messages

Tristan Riley

Newvoices.com.au

1 September 2015, 3.20 pm

Mandurah parents and their teenage children hit back at claims that they are out of control and need to act more responsibly following media reports about gate crashed parties over the weekend. They are sick of the negative stereotypes and blame they endure because of the behaviour of a minority group of youths and parents.

With a lack of support, activities and positive media messages, teenagers are given a bad rap. Parent groups say it is time to change this image.

Many teenagers are sick of being put into the same category as the minority of violent, out of control youths who are roaming the suburbs. Year 12 student Tamica Stock says she and her friends don't run amok but do enjoy much needed time away from their study. She says she has attended many parties that have been gate crashed by 'thugs', saying that 'a few troublemakers ruin it for all of us.'

Recent reports have claimed that parents have lost control over their children. Community parenting groups are concerned about the claim they are unable to act responsibly.

Parenting expert, Sarah Grimble, states that it is a damaging label to throw at all parents of teenagers. 'Most parents have reasonable boundaries for their children and don't buy alcoholic drinks for them,' she says. 'Most parents would never expect 15-year-old teenagers to bring alcohol to a birthday celebration. This is not normal for most families.'

While parents and teenagers don't deny this sort of antisocial and unruly behaviour is a problem, they don't think it is fair to tar them all with the same brush.

Activity and Questions

What is your opinion of the ‘out of control’ parties in the suburbs?

Record a detailed analysis of each article in the table provided in the ‘Comparison Table’ document and answer the questions which follow.

News report	Riot police called out to control drunk teens	Parents claim misleading messages
Summary of information the reporter has selected for article		

News report	Riot police called out to control drunk teens	Parents claim misleading messages
Words and phrases that have strong connotations and explain the effect of each example		
Summary of viewpoint conveyed about the event		The reporter has focused on the parent and teenage voices. The voices of the neighbours and people troubled by this behaviour are not included.
Explanation of who benefits and who is disadvantaged by representation of events		

Questions

1. How do the headlines indicate the emphasis of each story?

2. What differences are there in the language used to construct each article?

3. Who is the target audience for each article? Provide evidence from each article to support your answer.

4. What representation of youth is constructed by each article? What attitudes towards youth does this encourage?

SECTION 4

Annotated article – ‘Disturbing the peace’

Heading →

Disturbing the peace

By Alana Pride, *Newvoices.com.au*, 5 September 2010

By-line →

‘Our quiet streets may never regain their peace’ writes Alana Pride.

Opening paragraph → establishes viewpoint (contention)

This is a warning. But it has possibly come too late. Have we forfeited our peace? In suburbs across our country youths rampage and run amok on the streets. With total disregard for authority, they shout abuse, hurl rocks and mob front yards.

Why have we lost control of our youth? When will parents wake up to this alarm bell? It is time to regain the power and banish these teen terrors from our streets.

Rhetorical questions

The middle paragraphs → illustrate and expand on the contention

Imagine: a mob of 200 youths descending on a quiet cul-de-sac. Many drunk, most uninvited, they fall in, ready for battle. They are the ‘gatecrashers’ – getting a tip from their Facebook ‘friends’ of a party at this location. Fuelled with a desire to rebel they collect friends and scull spirits on the way, before imposing on unsuspecting residents.

This scene occurs regularly in our suburbs every Friday and Saturday night. Across Australia, gatecrashing has become an epidemic. **Youths with nothing better to do, with no regard for rules on the hunt for the next party to ambush.**

Generalisation

They are looking for trouble and they usually find what they are looking for. **Imagine: parents buy alcoholic drinks for their spotty-faced child and their child’s gangly friends. Parents then taxi these children to where they want to go. Without raising an eyebrow the parental body supervising this 15th birthday celebration allows these children inside. With stubby in hand he cheers them on through the door.** This is an image more appropriate for a 21st rather than a teen celebration. The lollies and soda seem to have been left off the shopping list.

Anecdote

Parents knowingly buy alcohol for their underage offspring. This is a **serious breach of responsibility.** Teenagers’ brains are not fully developed and such neglect could cause permanent damage. But still in every group of teenage friends there will be one willing parent, unable to draw the line.

Formal language

Imagine: riot police surrounding your street, unable to control this **pack of teens.** They are throwing glasses and rocks at windows. Neighbours duck for cover and police get ready to break them up. The scene seems unimaginable: riot police for a mob of drunken kids? These ‘kids’ leave behind a war zone of crushed glass, smashed windows, dented cars and blood.

Emotive language

Police have taken a stand and in Western Australia they have established Operation Petina. They intend to clean up the streets. This is a measure, a reaction and perhaps a necessity to control these youths. You wonder how it got to this point. Where are the parents? Who should be reacting to this behaviour? Reports show that teen violence is on the rise. The number of young people charged with assault has doubled since the late 1990s in Perth's suburbs.

Expert opinion and interview

Sergeant Peter Lovell told *Newsvoices.com.au* that police are seeing violent incidents every day. 'Youths have no respect, they are running amok with no regard for other citizens,' Lovell claims. He blames a lack of control in the home. 'Parents need to enforce some curfews and stop allowing their young children out at night unsupervised.' Children should be home in bed; instead they are roaming the streets, free from parental supervision.

Children's Court Magistrate, Harry Dawson, says that the number of youth crimes is on the rise, particularly those fuelled by substance abuse. He says children as young as ten are out all night, causing a path of destruction through quiet streets. 'They need stable homes, with clear rules and consequences'. Parents are in the spotlight with a government initiative to enforce fines for supplying alcohol to underage children. Sally Morrell from the *Herald Sun* reports that parents are looking at getting slapped with a \$6000 fine. There is an overwhelming outcry from communities Australia-wide that parents need to start taking more responsibility for their child's behaviour.

Use of factual information

Parenting expert Lisa Burton says that these formative years are the most important for the development of well-rounded and morally grounded adults. She writes in her new book, *Moral Parenting*, that alcohol abuse is often the starting point for creating dysfunctional and violent teenagers. Parents need to reinstate traditional values and put a stop to these behaviours.

Police are at their wits' end. Their job is to keep people safe and they have been forced to act. Riot gear seems drastic but if you were the neighbours caught up in these unimaginable scenes you would think differently. We cannot banish our youths, but we can say, enough is enough and put these kids back in their place.

Authoritative tone

Questions

1. What is Alana Pride saying about today's youth?

2. Who does the author advantage? Who is this article likely to disadvantage?

3. What attitude does Alana Pride encourage the audience to accept about youth?

Reader positioning analysis

Identify the language and selection choices used in the article.

Explain the techniques that are used to position the reader. Complete column 3 in the following table.

Device used	Example from 'Disturbing the peace'	Explanation of the purpose of this device and how it has positioned the reader
Generalisation a broad statement determined from a specific incident	<i>Youths with nothing better to do, with no regard for rules on the hunt for the next party to ambush</i> <i>There is an overwhelming outcry from communities Australia-wide, that parents need to start taking more responsibility for their child's behaviour.</i>	This statement generalises that all youths are unruly. It creates a negative image of young people and positions the reader to view them all as badly behaved.

Rhetorical question • a question which does not require an answer	<i>Why have we lost control of our youth? When will parents wake up to this alarm bell?</i>	
Anecdote • a personal or descriptive scenario about an event	<i>Imagine: parents buy alcoholic drinks for their spotty-faced child and their child's gangly friends. Parents then taxi these children to where they want to go. Without raising an eyebrow the parental body supervising this 15th birthday celebration allows these children inside. With stubby in hand he cheers them on through the door.</i>	
Formal language • use of sophisticated language which is often authoritative	<i>serious breach of responsibility</i>	

Emotive language words and phrases that evoke feelings and may have either negative or positive connotations	<i>pack of teens, duck for cover, war zone</i>	
Expert opinion and interview quotes and information from someone with expert knowledge in a particular field	<i>Sergeant Peter Lovell told Newsvoices.com.au that police are seeing violent incidents every day. 'Youths have no respect, they are running amok with no regard for other citizens,' Lovell claims.</i> <i>Children's Court Magistrate, Harry Dawson, says that the number of youth crimes is on the rise, particularly those fuelled by substance abuse. He says children as young as ten are out all night, causing a path of destruction through quiet streets. 'They need stable homes, with clear rules and consequences.'</i>	Quoting a police sergeant adds weight to the argument about youths' antisocial behaviours. Using an authority figure draws on common beliefs that their opinion is reliable and can be trusted.
Facts or statistics use of evidence to support a claim	<i>Sally Morrell from the Herald Sun reports that parents are looking at getting slapped with a \$6000 fine.</i>	

SECTION 5

Drugs: The conversation every parent should have with their kids

November 13, 2015 - 12:00AM



Karl Quinn

National Film Editor

The finding that Nick Cave's son had taken LSD before plunging to his death should stir open discussions between parents and children, not moralising.



Nick Cave and Susie Bick attend the inquest into their son's death at Brighton Coroner's Court on November 10, 2015 in Brighton, England. *Photo: Tabatha Fireman*

I can't begin to imagine the swirl of thoughts and emotions that flooded the mind and choked the heart of Nick Cave and his wife Susie Bick as they heard that their son Arthur Cave had taken LSD shortly before falling to his death from a cliff in Brighton, England, in July.

But I certainly *can* imagine the tut-tutting and head shaking that some people have indulged in upon hearing the news. The apple doesn't fall far from the tree and all that.

Turning a blind eye to drugs and all they represent is not a meaningful response, but that's what "just say no" demands of us.

If Arthur Cave – who was described by his parents as a "wonderfully unruly, creative and free-spirited young man" – had been dabbling with drugs, could anyone be surprised? After all, Nick Cave is one of the most famous ex-junkies on the planet. He has been clean for years, but has spoken openly of missing drink and drugs. How could Arthur have been expected to stay on the straight and narrow with a father like that?



Arthur Cave had LSD in his system when he fell to his death in Brighton in July, according to the coroner.

To the censorious I would say only this: pull your head in, get a grip, and engage with the reality of the world around you.

Drugs are everywhere. The blight of addiction and its attendant crime skews our understanding of the situation – they alter our perceptions, if you will, though not in a Huxleyan way. But they constitute a small part of a far greater picture.

Ice is a drug, and an ugly one at that; LSD is a drug, as is marijuana.

But so is alcohol. And nicotine. And the various prescription medicines that are used and abused by millions of law-abiding Australians, some of whom would no doubt be among the first to tut-tut and shake their heads.

The "just say no" line on drugs is moronic. At the very least, it demands a level of abstemiousness that is beyond most of us. Pour yourself a nice glass of red, as I did last night, and you've fallen at the first hurdle. Leave your desk for a sneaky fag, and bang – you just said yes.

Turning a blind eye to drugs and all they represent is not a meaningful response, but that's what "just say no" demands of us. Much better surely to say "well maybe, but make sure you know what you're messing with first, and take care".

Drugs are fun (or they can be). They are also dangerous (or they can be). Some of the time they're just meh. And for the small percentage who become addicted, they blot out everything else, first for better and later for worse.

I have a son – he's now 20 and backpacking through India with some mates – and a few years ago, as we were walking home from a party where most of the adults had consumed one drug (alcohol) while some of the teenagers snuck down an alleyway to consume another (marijuana), the conversation turned inevitably to what had just transpired.

"You know," he said, "It's weird that I can even talk to you about this."

"Hey, I don't want you to think I'm giving you the big seal of approval just because I'm not saying 'don't do it'."

"Well," he said, "that would be pretty hypocritical, wouldn't it?"

I was taken aback. We've never talked about what I may or may not have ingested. But he was right. It would have been hypocritical.

So instead we talked about the things that I think should be on the agenda if – though it really should be "when" – any parent's conversation with their kid turns to drugs.

Such as: smoking dope is not actually "harmless", especially where young developing brains are concerned; consumption of alcohol and other drugs affects your ability to make sensible decisions, and might endanger your safety; as a user, you have very little control over the quantity or quality of the "effective ingredients" in mind-altering substances such as mushrooms or acid or ecstasy (they don't exactly come with a label).

Above all, I told him, if you're doing this stuff, look after yourself, look after your mates, and treat the stuff you're using, and the people around you, with care and respect. And never, ever get in a car being driven by someone affected by anything.

It's obvious stuff, though not necessarily so to a teenager who thinks they're immortal, as most of them do.

If at this point you feel some tut-tutting and head shaking is in order, be my guest. Time will tell if I've got this wrong, but for now I'm willing to believe that my own wonderfully unruly, creative and free-spirited young man is making relatively informed choices about the risks he would likely be taking anyway.

I can't stop him taking LSD or anything else. But with any luck, he'll know to stay away from cliff edges if he does.

Karl Quinn is *The Age's* national film editor. Follow him on Facebook at [karl quinn writer](#) or on twitter at [@karlkwin](#)

For parental information on talking to your children about drugs go to [parentguides.com.au](#).

comments so far

- Good man, openness and honesty is the way I hope to go with my son. It seem people forget that the tried and ways of the past year no lauding the war on drugs are a complete fail. *One eye Carrum*
- ..."for now I'm willing to believe that my own wonderfully unruly, creative and free-spirited young man is making relatively informed choices about the risks he would likely be taking..."If you think he's telling you everything, you're deluded. Who sold the drug to the child? That's the real question.Who sells drugs to children? Can we look at that? Instead of putting the onus on the children, can we please put the onus on the dealers? *Sarajane Melbourne*
- Where are you coming from with a comment like,"Nick Cave is one of the most famous ex-junkies on the planet. He has been clean for years, but has spoken openly of missing drink and drugs. How could Arthur have been expected to stay on the straight and narrow with a father like that?
With a father being like that as you put it i would have thought he would have had a better chance of not becoming an addict
Drug addiction is NOT hereditary,like everyone else in the world he made choices andsadly they were the wrong ones *Screamer Sydney*
- But it was a juvenile choice. It was the choice a child made, as such it wasn't a choice. He didn't make a choice, he fell in to a choice. *Sarajane Melbourne*
- Terrific article,well written and above all.....right. Gave it a solemn nod on reading it. Talk to your children as tho' they are adults, Show them respect. Your likely to have that respect reciprocated.Give them a long leash but let them know where the boundaries are. Above all be honest,your not infallible and neither are they. Worked for us.
Iwantmore

- The kid made a choice and got it wrong. End of story. Everyday people make the choice to ingest drugs because they think they are smarter than the criminals who plot their fall into addiction. End of story. If we stop treating these people like victims and not promoters of drug use then the message may just get through that people are responsible for their own actions. If they chose drugs then they chose the consequences. The consequences are theirs. If they die, they die their choice. I simply can't care about people who don't care for themselves, there are simply too many good people who don't deserve the consequences of what drug users are causing to happen to our society. Drug users are the reason there is a drug industry, they are the architects of their own demise, without their demand for drugs to feed their addictions there is no drug industry. I couldn't give a stuff about any of these glazed losers. Cave laid the foundations for his own sons demise when he gave strength to the criminal drug pushers hands and was a more than willing user of their products. Tragic irony. He'll never hold his son in his arms again, makes you think, doesn't it? *Neil (not on radio) Mitchell Melbourne*
- You suffer an absence of humanity, empathy, call it what you will. Many people take many different decisions which may result in their death, but the fact that they freely made that decision doesn't mean some sorrow isn't warranted. Someone gets into a car, gets hit by another car and dies...their decision to get into a vehicle known for wreaking havoc shouldn't deprive them of our sadness. Someone enlists to do a dangerous job (defence, policing) and dies in the line of duty...their decision to take that path shouldn't rob them of our sorrow. Someone intervenes to save one person during an argument with someone else, then finds themselves the victim of lethal violence instead...simply a bad decision on their part? Serves them right? Sometimes people make noble decisions, sometimes they make decisions for banal reasons, and sometimes they make decisions from sheer human folly. In my view, all deserve a less judging and far kinder eye than the one you cast on the situation. *Days to Come Here and There*
- End of story? If they die they die? Tragic Irony? You are heartless. I can't believe your comment actually got through. *Sarajane Melbourne*
- "Everyday people make the choice to ingest drugs because they think they are smarter than the criminals who plot their fall into addiction." That's where I stopped reading. When I was a young adult - some long time ago now - I made a choice to try some drugs. It had nothing to do with thinking I was smarter than "criminals". I actually had no contact with proper "criminals", only friends who were buying it off friends or growing their own (pot). "Drug users are the reason there is a drug industry" Actually I read a bit more. Obviously you are having a dig at the pharmaceutical industry here? Or not. Anyway, prohibition is more of a reason there is a criminal black market drug industry, if that is what you meant. I still find it ironic that the biggest supporters of the war on drugs approach to enforcement would be criminal gangs because it allows them to charge a small fortune for what would otherwise not be worth very much at all. I wonder whether they

donate to outspoken anti-drug politicians. *Ross / Preston*

- There is a difference to my understanding.
Alcohol is legal, marijuana is not!! *Adrian Ashburton*

Read more: <http://www.theage.com.au/comment/drugs-what-every-parent-should-tell-their-kids-20151111-gkwna4.html#ixzz3rLdpk434>

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Questions

- 1 Identify examples of the following in the text. Explain their effects.
 - quotation
 - generalisation
 - emotive language
 - rhetorical question
 - anecdote

Device used	Example from 'Drugs: The conversation...'	Explanation of the purpose of this device and how it has positioned the reader
Quotation from an expert • quotes and information from someone with expert or particular knowledge of an aspect of the topic		

Device used	Example from 'Drugs: The conversation...'	Explanation of the purpose of this device and how it has positioned the reader
Generalisation a broad statement determined from a specific incident		
Emotive language words and phrases that evoke feelings and may have either negative or positive connotations		
Rhetorical question a question which does not require an answer		

Device used	Example from 'Drugs: The conversation...'	Explanation of the purpose of this device and how it has positioned the reader
Anecdote a personal or descriptive scenario about an event		

2. What perspective is the writer taking on drugs? What other perspectives can be seen in the comments?

3. What effects do the pictures and hyperlinks have?

Use the notes following to write two 200-300 words short answers

4. Summarise the ideas the writer presents about drugs and explain his perspective.
5. How does the writer influence his audience to respond to his perspective on drugs?

NOTES

Ideas presented

Topic – death of Nick Cave’s son (LSD)

Main idea – there should be open discussion between parents and children about drugs, not moralising.

Moralising or ‘just say no’ means turning a blind eye, is not a meaningful response.

Not surprising Nick Cave’s son experimented with drugs.

Drugs are everywhere.

There are bad and abused drugs, also used and less harmful drugs. Most people take drugs. Drugs can be fun.

Better to have understanding of drugs and take care.

Young people should be advised truthfully and not hypocritically about the risks of drugs. Parents should have a conversation with their kids and advise them to act with care and respect with regard to drugs.

Perspective

Personal

Parent/father (to other parents/adults)

Realist, Common sense

Modern

Knowledgeable

How does the writer influence the audience to see things his way?

Clear statement of main idea at the beginning.

Creating sympathy for the family of Arthur Cave, emotive language

Structuring an argument against ‘tut – tutting’ with clear points.

Directly addressing opponents using common idiom “pull your head in..”

Shades of meaning, big picture view. Sees more than one side to the argument.

Vocab – blight abstemiousness (formal language) Varied - ‘sneaky fag’

- Addresses readers
- Personal anecdote, quoting/dialogue
- Short sentences for emphasis. 'drugs are everywhere' 'But he was right'
- Clear, 'common sense' approach in language eg 'stuff'
- Ending wraps it all together and is memorable.
- Link to further information/experts

Summarise the ideas the writer presents about drugs and explain his perspective

How does the writer influence his audience to respond to his perspective on drugs?

[illegible]